

What else to watch: *Cool Hand Luke* (1967) ■ *Midnight Express* (1978) ■ *Escape from Alcatraz* (1979) ■ *The Shining* (1980, p.339) ■ *Sleepers* (1996) ■ *The Green Mile* (1999) ■ *The Majestic* (2001) ■ *The Mist* (2007) ■ *A Prophet* (2009)

It is this hope that impels Andy to turn the tables on the brutal Warden Norton (Bob Gunton), who exploits Andy's bookkeeping skills in order to launder money. Each night, Andy chips away at his cell wall in order to carry out an escape that is 20 years in the making. His determination also inspires his friend Red (Morgan Freeman) to find his own redemption.

Paying the price

In contrast, fellow inmate Brooks Hatlen (James Whitmore) is so dependent on the certainties of prison life that he dreads his release. When Brooks is let out on parole in 1954, he is shown attempting to cross a road, shocked by the speed of traffic, overwhelmed in an enormous world. Brooks is neither weak nor cowardly, but he does not know how to cope.

Time in prison can change people, often for the worse, and this is



Frank Darabont Director

The child of Hungarian immigrants, Frank Darabont was born in

1959 in a refugee camp in Montbéliard, France, and moved with his family to the US as an infant. He began his career with various jobs on movie sets, including as production assistant on the horror movie *Hell Night* (1981). His first full feature was *The Shawshank Redemption*, an adaptation of a Stephen King

short story. This brought him worldwide acclaim and an Oscar nomination. He directed more adaptations of King's work in *The Green Mile* and *The Mist*, before working on TV horror series *The Walking Dead* between 2010 and 2011.

Key movies

1994 *The Shawshank Redemption*
1999 *The Green Mile*
2007 *The Mist*

what makes Andy's fortitude so miraculous. *The Shawshank Redemption* suggests that it is possible for a person to hold on to their self-worth even in the very direst of circumstances, and to maintain their humanity even in the face of the most inhumane treatment. ■

Fellow lifer Red (Morgan Freeman) is drawn by the steely determination of Andy (Tim Robbins) not to be broken. Red's slow, measured voice-over as the movie's narrator adds to its somber dignity.

